

# Findings Report

Likitha Vankadoth · Data: DCCEEW Biodiversity Offsets Scheme registers, extracted 5 Oct 2026

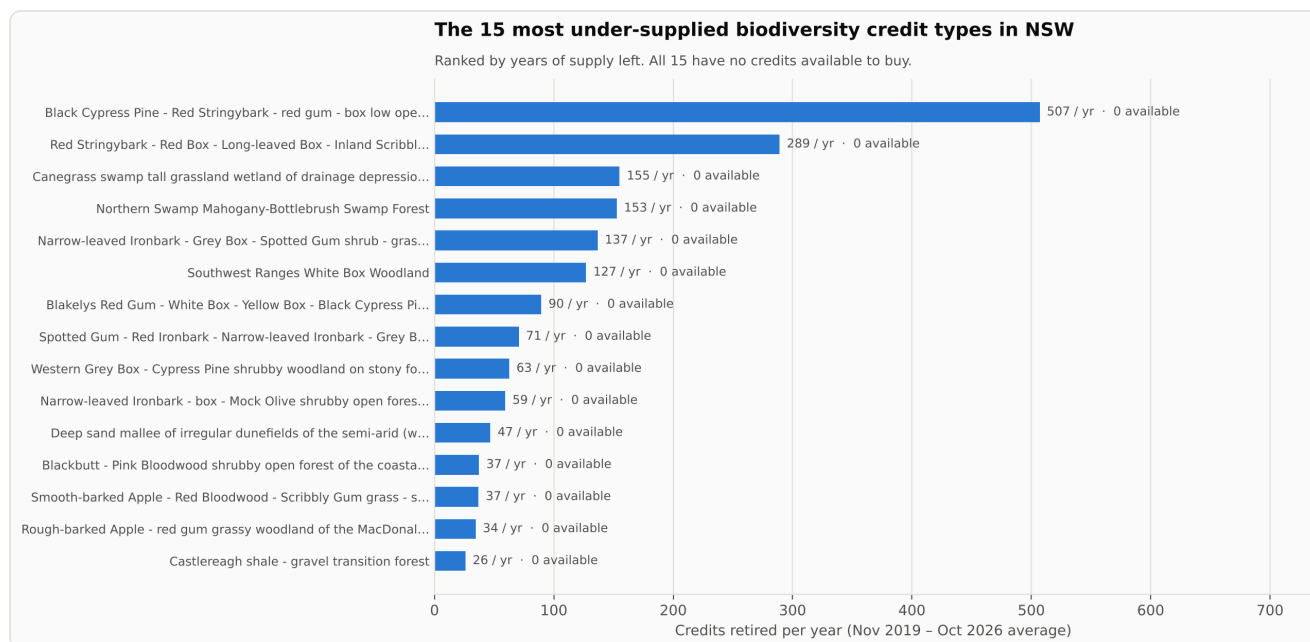
**Question:** which biodiversity credit types in NSW are most under-supplied relative to demand?  
**Data:** DCCEEW Biodiversity Offsets Scheme registers, extracted 5 October 2026 (2,826 supply records; 2,554 transactions from November 2019 to October 2026). **Method:** see the [README](#).  
In short, *years of supply = credits available ÷ credits retired per year*, calculated for each credit type.

## Summary

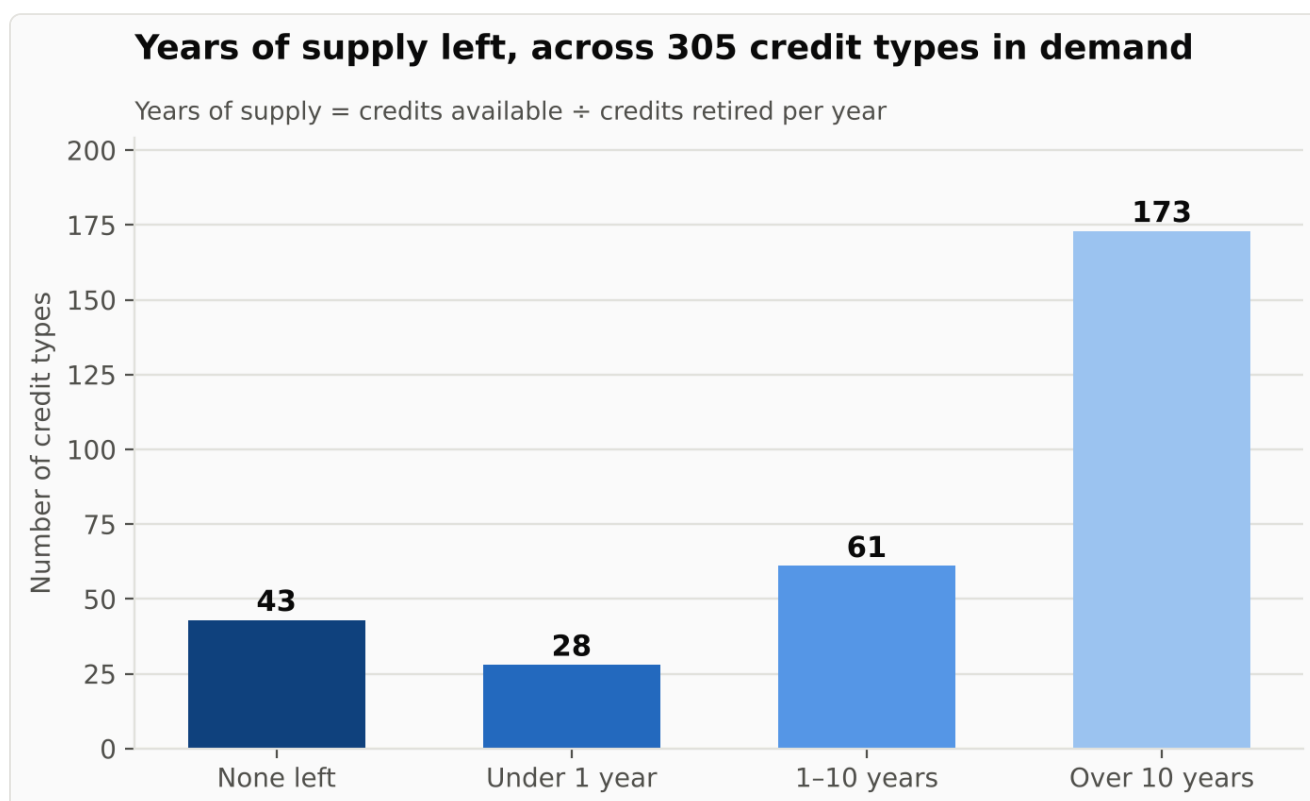
| Measure                                                        | Result                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Credit types retired against offset obligations                | <b>305</b>             |
| ... with <b>zero</b> credits available today                   | <b>43</b> (14%)        |
| ... with <b>under 1 year</b> of supply left (including the 43) | <b>71</b> (23%)        |
| Median years of supply across all 305 types                    | 17.8 years             |
| Credits retired in total                                       | 281,579                |
| Credits available now (Issued + Equivalence)                   | 1,172,603              |
| Credits in the pipeline (Pending Review)                       | 781,328                |
| Value of credit sales, 2019 – Oct 2026 (ex GST)                | ≈ <b>\$726 million</b> |

**In one sentence:** the market as a whole has plenty of credits, but they are the wrong kinds in the wrong places. Nearly a quarter of the credit types developers actually need will run out within a year, and most of those have nothing in the pipeline to replace them.

# 1. Shortages are concentrated in specific vegetation types



- The 15 scarcest credit types are **all ecosystem credits with zero supply**.
- The top-ranked type, *Black Cypress Pine – Red Stringybark – red gum – box low open forest* of the NSW South Western Slopes, is retired at about **507 credits a year** with none available.
- Shortages cluster in two areas:
- **Inland woodlands and dry forests of the NSW South Western Slopes and Riverina** (ranks 1, 2, 7 and 9)
- **Ironbark, Spotted Gum and Grey Box forests of the Hunter** (ranks 5, 8 and 10)
- Of the 43 zero-supply types, **39 are ecosystem credits and 4 are species credits**.



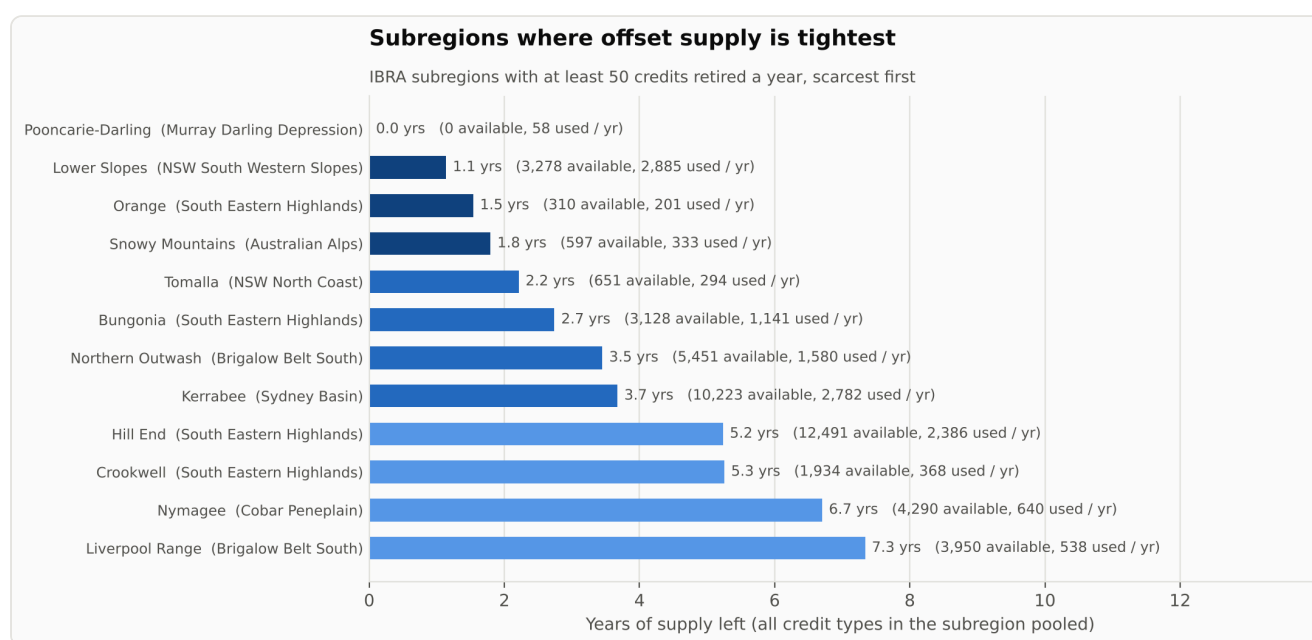
Most credit types (173 of 305) have more than 10 years of supply. The market is not short everywhere: it is **lopsided**.

## 2. Scarce species credits

| Rank | Species                                                 | Available | Retired per year | Years left |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------------|------------|
| 16   | Harrow Wattle ( <i>Acacia acanthoclada</i> )            | 0         | 18               | 0          |
| 20   | <i>Pimelea curviflora</i> var. <i>curviflora</i>        | 0         | 6                | 0          |
| 54   | Tarengo Leek Orchid ( <i>Prasophyllum petilum</i> )     | 162       | 503              | 0.3        |
| 55   | Pine Donkey Orchid ( <i>Diuris tricolor</i> )           | 168       | 503              | 0.3        |
| 59   | Superb Parrot ( <i>Polytelis swainsonii</i> )           | 31        | 62               | 0.5        |
| 66   | Singleton Mint Bush ( <i>Prostanthera cineolifera</i> ) | 19        | 22               | 0.9        |

By contrast, **Koala credits are well supplied**: about 70,000 are available, 20 years at the current rate, with a further 78,000 pending.

## 3. Where supply is tightest geographically



Pooling all credit types within each IBRA subregion (subregions with at least 50 credits retired a year):

- **Lower Slopes** (NSW South Western Slopes) is under the most pressure. About 2,900 credits are used a year, with only about 1.1 years of supply.
- **Orange, Bungonia, Hill End and Crookwell** (South Eastern Highlands) all have less than 6 years.
- **Pooncarie-Darling** (Murray Darling Depression) has demand but no supply listed at all.

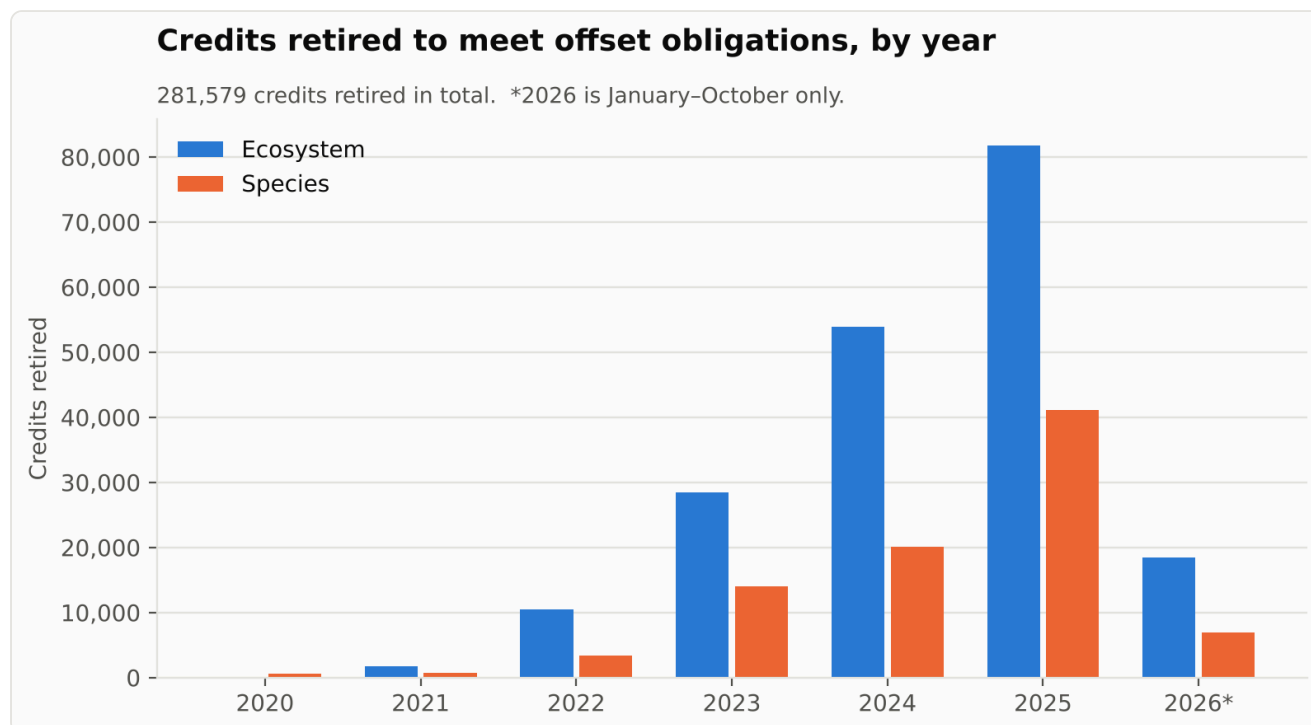
These subregions are where **new stewardship sites would be most valuable**, both environmentally and commercially.

*Caveat: pooling by subregion is a broad view. Real like-for-like rules match on vegetation type or species, so the credit-type ranking in section 1 is the more precise measure.*

## 4. The pipeline will not fix most shortages

- Of the **71** credit types with under a year of supply, only **16** have any credits under review (Pending Review), and only **14** have enough pending to cover a year of demand.
- So **about 4 in 5 of the scarcest credit types have nothing coming**. Without new stewardship agreements, proponents will increasingly have to pay into the Biodiversity Conservation Fund or rely on variation rules.

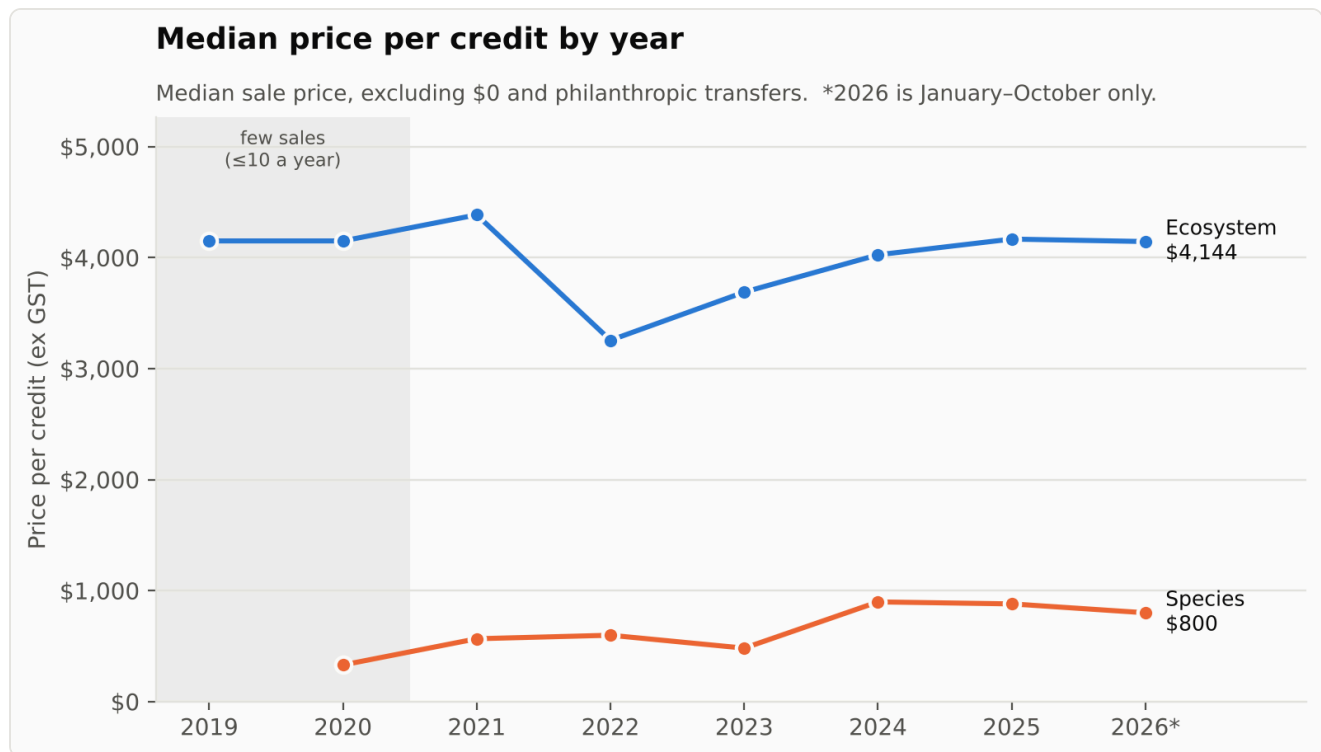
## 5. Demand has grown fast



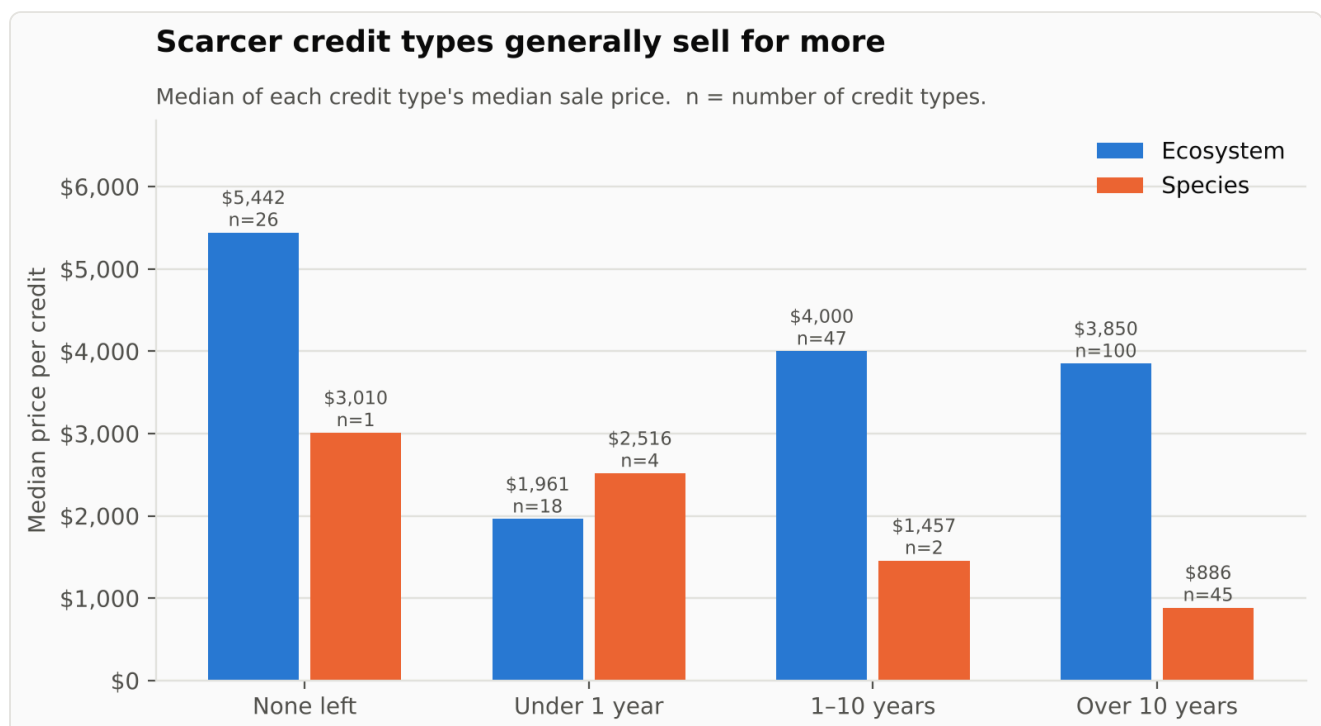
- Credits retired rose from about **2,000 in 2021 to about 123,000 in 2025**.
- Retirement transactions grew from 36 in 2021 to 356 in 2025.
- **90%** of retired credits were retired to meet a planning or clearing approval. **6%** were retired by the Biodiversity Conservation Trust to meet its obligations.
- Demand is **concentrated**: the 10 most-retired credit types account for **40%** of all credits retired.

**Implication:** the ranking uses the 6.8-year average rate. Recent demand is well above that average, so actual years of supply for many credit types are **shorter** than shown.

## 6. Prices

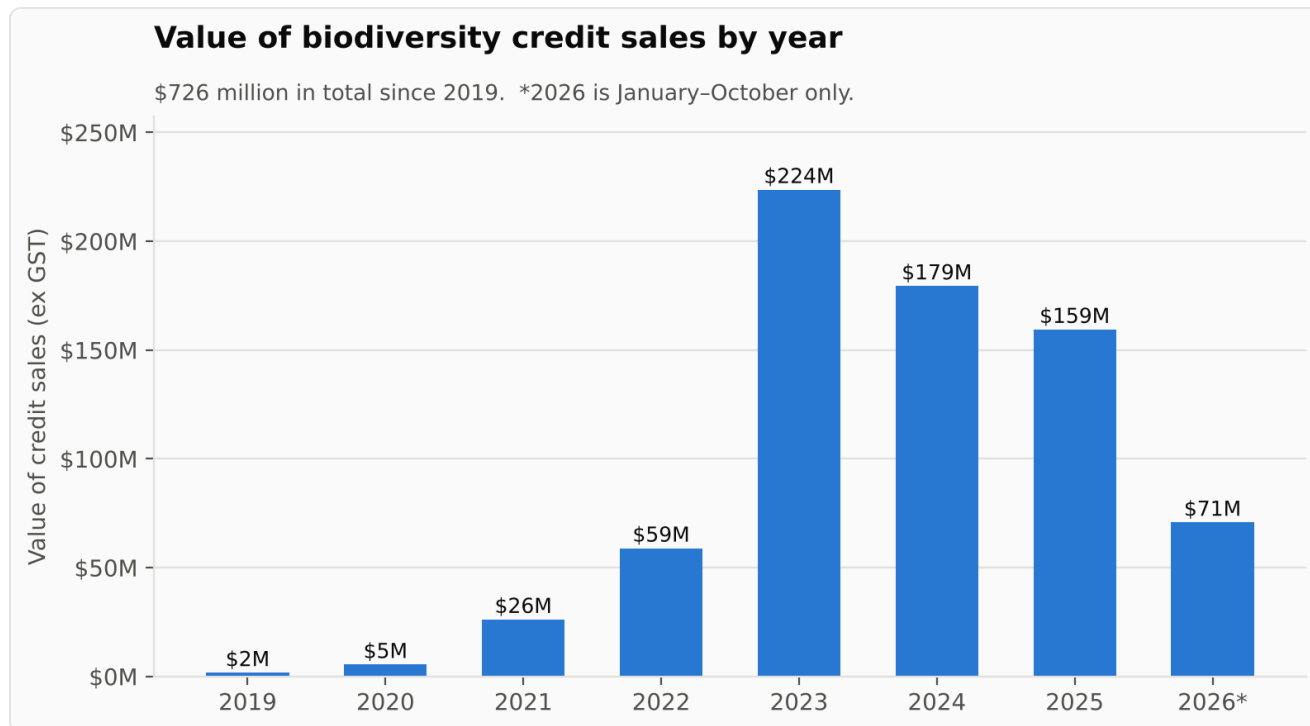


- **Ecosystem credits** are steady at a median of about **\$3,300–\$4,400** per credit.
- **Species credits** have **more than doubled**, from about \$330 (2020) to \$800–\$900 (2024–2026).
- 2019–2020 had very few sales (10 or fewer a year), so treat those years with caution.



- Ecosystem credit types with **no supply left** sell for a median of **\$5,442**, about **40% more** than plentiful types (\$3,850). This supports the scarcity ranking.

- The "under 1 year" ecosystem group breaks the pattern (\$1,961). Possible reasons are a small group (18 types) and older sales made before those types became scarce.
- Species credits show a clear gradient (\$886 for plentiful types, \$2,500–\$3,000 for scarce ones), but there are very few scarce species, so this is indicative only.



- Credit sales are worth **about \$726 million** in total. The peak was **\$224 million in 2023**.
- Sale value has eased since 2023 even as retirements kept rising. A likely reason is that more retirements now use credits bought earlier or created by the proponent's own stewardship site, but the registers alone cannot confirm this.

## 7. What this means

| For                                                   | Implication                                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Developers and consultants</b>                     | Check supply early for South Western Slopes, Hunter and South Eastern Highlands vegetation types. Expect to pay more, or to need fund payments or variation rules. |
| <b>Landowners</b>                                     | Stewardship sites with scarce PCTs (section 1) or in tight subregions (section 3) have the strongest demand and prices.                                            |
| <b>Biodiversity Conservation Trust and government</b> | About 55 of the 71 scarcest credit types have no supply pipeline. They are candidates for targeted procurement or incentives.                                      |
| <b>Data owners (DCCEEW)</b>                           | Consistent PCT naming across registers, a PCT ID in the transactions register, and real Excel exports would make the market much easier to analyse.                |

## Limitations

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See the README for the full list. The main ones are that demand is measured from retirements (unmet demand is invisible), the data is a point-in-time snapshot, and the like-for-like matching is simplified.

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Register data © State of New South Wales (DCCEEW), CC BY 4.0. Code and analysis: [github.com/Likithaa07/nsw-biodiversity-credit-gap](https://github.com/Likithaa07/nsw-biodiversity-credit-gap)